Spacing and recall

Learners who spread their reviews out remembered more a month later than learners who crammed, though both groups did about as well the next day. Table 1 lists each group.

Schedule	Learners	Day 1	Day 30
Spaced	412	91%	74%
Massed	398	93%	41%
Control	120	88%	37%

Table 1: Recall after one day and after thirty days.

The chance of recalling an item falls with the time t since it was last seen, at a rate set by its stability S:

$$R(t) = e^{-t/S}, \qquad S_{n+1} = S_n \cdot (1 + \alpha)$$

Each successful review raises S, so the next gap can be longer than the last one.